



Camera

It was just around a decade back that we saw the first mobile phone with a camera module - the Sharp J-SHO4. Do you want to take a guess at how many pixels it encompassed? It had



110,000 - pixels, for those who aren't laughing, that's a mere 0.1 MP. However, not long after this, the mobile industry went ablaze with the craze for camera phones. From selling 3 million units in 2001, the industry saw the sale of 500 million units in 2006. In fact, the manufacturers then were coming up with series

of dedicated camera phones, few of the notable ones were from the K-series phones by Sony Ericsson. Apart from launching dedicated camera phones, the fight for encompassing higher mega-pixels also took off around the same time. From 0.1 to 0.3, and then as high as 12.0 - the mega-pixel war still rages - albeit not with as much fervour as before. Today, it's all about pixels still, but instead of still images, it's more about video quality. Thanks to TV manufacturers spending all the big bucks on advertising and making "HD" a household phrase, phone manufacturers now just flaunt their device's ability to shoot HD videos as a USP. All of us now expect, at a minimum, to have one converged device that is a phone, digital camera and camcorder all rolled into one - only if it also computes is it considered a bonus!



BlackBerry

If it's Business it's BlackBerry, no matter anyone says, BlackBerry devices are still the favourite toy for suited men - despite BlackBerry (RIM) themselves trying to break the mold with their own ads. With about 70 million subscribers (as of October 2011), it's obvious that RIM is still a force to



be reckoned with. It also helps that a lot of Gen-Y have started seeing BBM as the best messaging solution out there - which it actually is. Whether you're a 'Blackberry Boy', or a CEO, especially in India, where BlackBerry plans have become even cheaper than ever before - RIM and it's BlackBerry devices are surely here to stay.



Dont' you hold me like that

'Just avoid holding it in that way', was Steve Jobs infamous response when the iPhone 4 struggled with reception issues - better known as the Death Grip. The HTC Sensation was another smartphone that faced a similar issue. It's baffling how tech giants could make such mistakes when designing their flagship phones. Perhaps it's because the pressure of having to release updated models in

a hurry, or the fact that if one doesn't the competition surely will that causes such massive



oversights. Whatever the reasons, be prepared for more such events in the future, and we'll be only too happy to report them to you, as and when they happen.

40,000

Windows Phone market place now holds more than 40,000 apps Just a year after Win-

dows Phone was launched, the market place now is home for more than 40,000 apps. While the Apple App Store offers more than 5 lakh apps and the Android market place offering more than 3 lakh apps, Windows Phone still has a long long way to go. But the rate at which apps are being developed for the Windows platform it won't be surprising if it crosses the 50k mark by the end of 2011 or by January 2012 end; as of now 165 apps are being added every day.



User Experience

From simply packing in features, manufacturers are now paying attention to the nuances of user experience. Small changes such as well thought out placement of physical keys



Zzzzzz

Without a battery, all you can do with a phone is throw it at someone in anger, or use it to defend yourself, and even that will be unsuccessful, given that the darn things are so dainty and light these days. So what's happening in battery research then? Wads of cash are being spent in this direction, but we seem to have hit physical and chemical limits, and it's pretty much just nap time for anyone trying to find something exciting here... come on nanotechnology, or something...give us our 1 week battery, we beg you!



on the device, to letting you access the camera and apps right from the lockscreen, etc, are much more important today than ever before, and billions wait to be made for those who get it right!



Gorilla Glass

Manufactured by Corning, Gorilla Glass is an alkali-aluminosilicate thin sheet glass, which is specifically developed to be thin, light and resistant to damage. This makes it a perfect choice for the plethora of touch-screen mobile devices. There are many videos on the web that demonstrate the extent to which the Gorilla Glass can take

a beating. It was a project that started in 2006 and as of today it used in as much as 20 per cent of all mobile handsets. Thank God someone is making these devices more sturdy. Watch the video at <http://goo.gl/pPdH2>

